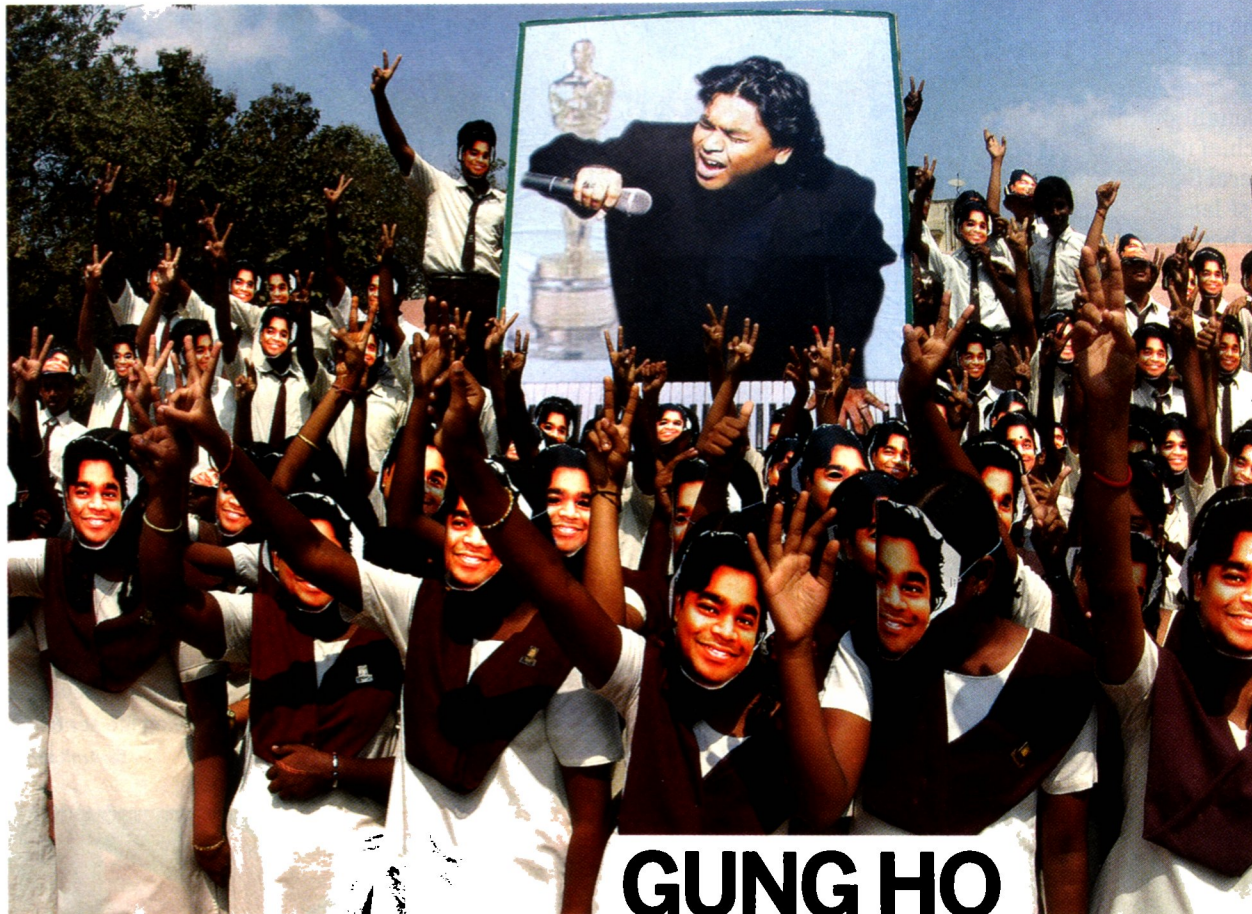


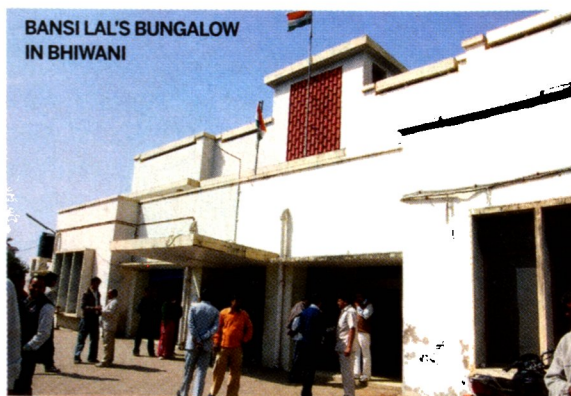


AS THE RAGS-to-riches romance *Slumdog Millionaire* swept the Oscars in Los Angeles, thousands of students took to the streets in Chennai in A.R. Rahman masks to celebrate the composer's double win for Original Score and Original Song for *Jai ho*. The Mozart of Madras has the world dancing to his tunes.

CHANDIGARH | Family Feud

Former chief minister Bansi Lal's family is washing its dirty linen in public. A day after Lal's widow Vidya Devi's last rites, a simmering feud between Lal's son MLA Ranbir Singh Mahendra and socialite daughter-in-law Kiran Choudhry, also Haryana's minister for tourism and forests, erupted again. The dispute is Lal's ancestral bungalow in Bhiwani where, on February 21, Mahendra's men allegedly broke open the locks and took over the property. Choudhry and Mahendra are already locked in a dispute over the ownership of Lal's multi-crore property in Delhi. Mahendra has the support of his sister Saroj, a Haryana IAS officer, and brother-in-law and MLA Somvir Singh. Choudhry is the widow of Lal's second son Surender Singh and is known for her proximity to Sonia Gandhi. She has been trying to launch her daughter Shruti into politics as the Congress Lok Sabha candidate from Bhiwani.

by Ramesh Vinayak



FORMER CHIEF MINISTER BANSI LAL'S FAMILY IS LOCKED IN A BITTER DISPUTE OVER HIS HOUSE, WHICH MAY TAKE A POLITICAL TURN.